

Measuring length with informal units

measure the length of shapes and objects using informal units, recognising that units need to be uniform and used end-to-end.

Learning intention

- measure the length of shapes and objects using informal units, recognising that units need to be uniform and used end-to-end.

Teach and model

- using 2 different units.
- measuring and comparing the length of objects using blocks.
- measuring the distance between 2 locations using footsteps, comparing the results and explaining why there may be different results.

Check understanding

- Explain the main idea and give one accurate example.
- Show the idea in a second way: with words, a model, a diagram or symbols.
- Apply the idea to a short unfamiliar situation and justify the result.

Teaching cautions

- Ask the student to explain their choice, not only state an answer.
- Check that key vocabulary is understood in a new example.
- Mix representations so the skill is transferred rather than copied.

Quick lesson sequence

- Connect to prior knowledge and introduce the key vocabulary.
- Model one clear example, then solve a second example together.
- Finish with an independent check and a short student explanation.